Activating a New Accounting Firm

How the ESource team sets up, launches, and supports a white-label firm

ESource AI Group

How the system works

One app

The same program serves every firm. Fixes made once reach everyone.

A profile per firm

The firm's web address picks its name, logo, color, and plan.

License Service

Sign-in codes, plan limits, counts, and the unlock key. No client data.

Firm computers

Books and backups stay on each computer, locked to the firm.

The promise to firms: client bank data never leaves their office. ESource sees counts and random book IDs only.

Before you activate

Signed agreement

The white-label license is signed by both sides. Details are being finalized.

Plan and tier

The firm's client book limit is agreed in writing. Prices are final; use the calculator.

Security and backup plan

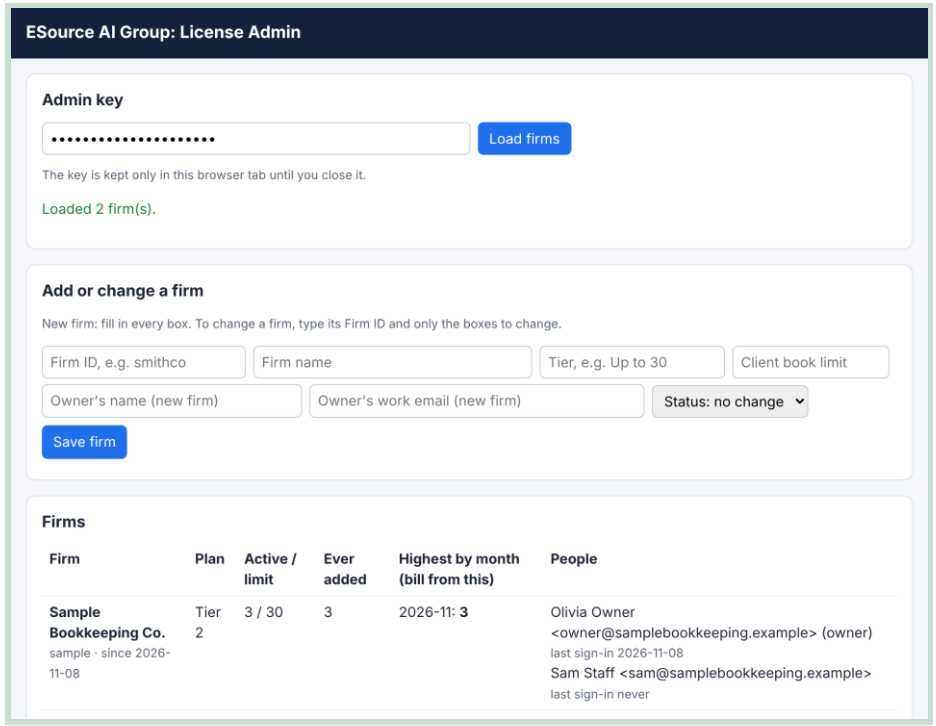
The firm has our Information Security and Backup Plan and names a security lead.

Firm details

Firm name, logo file, brand color, web address, and the owner's name and work email.

Step 1: Add the firm on the admin page

- Open admin.html: Go to app.esourcebookkeeper.com/admin.html and enter the admin key.
- Choose a Firm ID: Short, lowercase, no spaces, for example smithco. It never changes.
- Fill in the firm: Name, tier, client book limit, owner's name, and owner's work email.
- Save and check: Click Save firm, then Load firms. The firm shows 0 of its limit.



Step 2: Brand the firm's profile

- Copy the whitelabel block in profiles.js and rename it for the firm
- Set name (top of the screen) and firm (on client reports)
- Add the logo file to the logos folder and set logo
- Set the brand color and a new storage key
- Set license.firm to the Firm ID from Step 1
- Add the firm's web address to BA_HOSTS

5 min

Claude can make this change and push it to GitHub. Every client report then says "Prepared by" the firm.

Step 3: Give the firm its web address

1. **Pick the address** A subdomain such as smithco.esourcebookkeeper.com, or the firm's own domain.

2. **Add it in Vercel** bookkeepers-assistant project, Settings, Domains, Add. Note the DNS record shown.

3. **Add the record in Cloudflare** DNS, Records, Add record. Copy the value exactly. Set the cloud to gray, DNS only.

4. **Wait for the checkmark** Click Refresh in Vercel until it turns blue or green. Test the address.

Step 4: The owner's first sign-in

1. **Send the welcome** Give the owner the web address, the user guide, and the firm's getting-started course.
2. **Owner signs in** They type their work email and the 6-digit code emailed to them.
3. **Owner adds staff** On the License tab, add each person's name and work email.
4. **Confirm it works** Each staff member signs in once. You see them on the admin page.
5. **Bring clients over** On the Upload tab, the owner drops the old software's reports. Start with one client together.

Step 5: Help assistant, reminders and AI

Help assistant

In the firm's profile, keep ESource's assistant ID, or leave it blank for none. It answers how-to questions and never sees books.

Firm's own domain

If the firm uses its own web address, add it to the assistant's allowed websites in ElevenLabs, or it won't start there.

Reminders

Calendar and one-click text or email work right away. Automatic email stays off until the owner turns it on.

✦ AI features

Off until the owner turns them on in the License tab. 30 AI actions per client book each month; ESource pays the AI cost.

Monthly billing

- Open admin.html and click Load firms
- Read each firm's "Highest by month" number
- Bill from that number, using the firm's tier rates
- "Ever added" never goes down, so deleting and re-adding still counts
- A firm over its limit shows in red: offer the next tier
- Help minutes: 10 per book included; extra packs are paid through Stripe and added by themselves

Peak count

Firms are billed on the highest number of active client books on any day of the month, across all their staff.

Common support questions

An employee left

The owner removes them on the License tab. Their computer locks at its next check-in.

Lost or stolen laptop

Remove that person's access. The books on it stay locked.

Locked after 14 days

The computer went 14 days without internet. They sign in again.

Can't add a client

Either offline, or the plan is full. Offer the next tier.

New computer

Sign in, then Restore from backup on the Status tab.

Out of help minutes

They click Buy more minutes. After paying, Refresh on the License tab shows them.

More support questions

Is my work saved?

Look at the badge in the top bar. Green means saved. Red means download a backup now.

A line won't change

It shows "🔒 Filed year". That year's tax return was marked filed, so it's locked.

Fix a filed year

Only the owner can click Open [year] again on Setup, and must type a reason.

Who approved this?

Backup & Excel tab, Approval history. Download as Excel to send it.

Can't find a client

Click the Client box and type a few letters, or press "/". No client limit.

Transfer is off

On the Balance Sheet pink box, click Find unmatched to see the line with no other side.

Reports and requests from firms

- Firms use Report & Request, the last item in their menu
- Each report is emailed to ESource and saved on admin.html
- Click Load reports; newest first
- Set each one: New, Working on it, Fixed, or Won't fix
- Add a short note, and reply to the sender by email
- Bring each one to Joe and Claude for a fix

Listen

Every report is a problem a firm would otherwise call about. Fix it once, and every firm gets the fix.

You're ready to activate a firm

Checklist: agreement signed, admin page, profile, web address, owner sign-in, monthly billing

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